The Dhāraṇī Called Vajra Meteoric Iron Beak

Vajralohatuṇḍanāmadhāraṇī · Toh 965 · Derge Kangyur

རྡོ་རྗེ་ལྕགས་རྨ་ལས་མཆུ་ཞེས་བྱ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī Called Vajra Meteoric Iron Beak, known in Sanskrit as the Vajralohatuṇḍanāmadhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Dorje Namchak Chu zhe jawai zung, is a short protective incantation addressed to the dangers posed by hostile nāgas and destructive weather. It opens with the gods Brahmā, Viṣṇu, and Maheśvara, together with the Four Great Kings, circling the Blessed One and asking him to bless a dhāraṇī they wish to recite. They describe it as a formula that seizes and crushes the hearts of vicious nāgas, ruins their lineages, turns back storms of wind and hail, and makes flowers, fruits, and crops flourish for the benefit of all beings. The Buddha then responds by empowering its recitation, making the text a practical rite for safeguarding the harvest and the natural world. It is Toh 965 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the collection of incantations valued for their protective and beneficial power.

In the language of India: vajralohatuṇḍanāmadhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī Called Vajra Meteoric Iron Beak.

Homage to the Omniscient One.

Then Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Maheśvara, and the Four Great Kings circled the Blessed One three times, bowed to him, and said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, all of us have gathered here, and we wish to recite the dhāraṇī called Vajra Meteoric Iron Beak. It steals the hearts of all nāgas and crushes their hearts. It brings ruin on the lineages of the vicious nāgas. It turns back all clouds of wind and hail. It makes all flowers, fruits and crops flourish. Blessed One, for the benefit of all sentient beings, please bless it."

Then the Blessed One said to Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Maheśvara, and the Four Great Kings: "Sons of good family, empowered by me for the benefit of all sentient beings, and by the blessing of the truth of all the noble ones, speak it!"

Then Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Maheśvara, and the Four Great Kings spoke this dhāraṇī-mantra:

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the Blessed One Śākyamuni. Homage to all the tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly complete buddhas. Homage to the fierce Vajradhara. Homage to the mighty ones who overpower their adversaries. Homage to the lord of the three worlds. Homage to the Four Great

Kings. Homage to the blazing, vicious, fiercely laughing Vajra Meteoric Iron.

matha matha pramatha pramatha jalita vikṛta vajra jaya jaya mahābalebhyora viravarākrama krodharāja bramabhapupuma pramasvare bho bho nāgadevidi byisaramadha pramadhanadhena mūdtānāṃ sphoṭayāṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ bhara bhara varnacakra hādhani bho pannāgendra mātikramatha varṇacakre śiracintāṇi hūṃti hūṃtili hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ mudu mudu muhyentu sarva duṣṭhana sphoṭaya hṛdaya maheśvara jvalata triśūladhara dhara hana hana hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ muci muci dudi vabha vabha kṣaṇe kṣaṇe caturṇāṃ mahārājānāṃ jālati śakti dhara dhara hūṃ phaṭ spura spura vispura vispura vispura cararba cararba cararba nāśaya duṣṭaṃ nāgahṛdaya sphoṭaya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ duṣṭa āśāni bhuttamagaśa vīrya jvala bhasmiṃ kuru hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā samayamanusmaraya bho nāgādhipati vicintu bhyibhoya bho bhotu titu titu hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā vajra aśani nāśaya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā vajra aśani nāśaya hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā sarva nāgahṛdayāni visphoṭakāya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā buddhavilokitāya svāhā prahma svāhā viṭhṇumūrtāya svāhā maheśvara jvalita triśūlāya svāhā caturmahārāja samdharāya svāhā vicagatiya phaṭ svāhā oṃ diri diri svāhā jvalita vaktrāya svāhā juti juti svāhā phaṭ phaṭ

The moment they heard this dhāraṇī-mantra called Blazing Vajra Meteoric Iron Beak, the bodies of all the vicious nāgas rotted and gave off a foul stench. With their bodies falling apart and on the point of death, they touched the feet of the Blessed One and said: "Blessed One, please protect us! We have become despised by everyone, by the world together with its gods. We have been vicious. Blessed One, from now on we will not harm the sentient beings in Jambudvīpa, and we will not kill them. We will not so much as cast a glance at them, let alone watch for an opportunity to harm them."

Then Sāgara the nāga king, the nāga king Parasol-like, the nāga king Great Might, Great Radiance, Fierce, and others, hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of nāgas, touched their heads to the feet of the Blessed One and bowed. And all the nāgas said: "In times to come we will not harm any sentient being of Jambudvīpa. We will protect all flowers, fruits, crops, leaves and branches. We will hold back all wind and hail. We will make rain fall at the proper times. Thus we will keep the pledge of our own words of oath and the sacred commitment of the Tathāgata. We will fulfill the hopes of all sentient beings and bring to completion all that they wish for in their minds. We will do no harm. Blessed One, if we transgress these special virtues, may we never become fully and perfectly awakened in enlightenment. And these are our

words of oath:

tadyathā oṃ tagicagi ghuli ghuli muli śaśa guguśiti viramati huyu huyu svāhā"

When there is heavy rain, or when rain does not fall, or when rain falls out of season, or when wind, clouds, hail, cold winds, or thunderbolts strike, one should go onto a rooftop, a high place, or a mountaintop, face the east, and recite this oath formula of the vidyādharas seven times in a loud voice. If one recites it seven times over white mustard seed and throws the seed upward, then as soon as it is thrown, all the nāgas will be broken into pieces, and if one applies oneself earnestly, rain will quickly fall.

If, with this same dhāraṇī, one recites twenty-one times over a bell and twenty-one times over white mustard seed, and then forcefully and fiercely scatters the seed in the four directions, a boundary will be sealed. By reciting the Vajra Meteoric Iron Beak eight times one should summon the nāgas, and by calling it to mind once one should turn back wind and hail. Even if thunderbolts fall, they will turn into water. If one whirls a vajra, the hail will be driven away from whatever direction it is whirled toward. If one sits in a solitary place early in the morning and recites this mantra thirty-two times, wind, clouds and hail will cease. The nāgas will do no harm, and later too they will be unable to strike. If one enchants white mustard seed with the mantra and scatters it in the four directions, a boundary will be sealed for one year, and wind, clouds and hail will not stir. The nāgas will heed one's word, protect on every side, and carry out one's tasks. If one recites the mantra twenty-one times and rings a bell, their brains will burst and they will fall to the ground, and so those who cause harm are cleared away.

Having made offerings properly and offered praise, one recites it in a clear voice. If one then scatters white mustard seed in the four directions, above and below, hail, wind, and the harm done by nāgas will be bound. Evil omens, unwholesome things, inauspiciousness, planets (grahas), bhūtas, piśācas, yakṣas, and rākṣasas will also be driven away. A boundary will be sealed for a league all around. Diseases, those who intend harm, and all hostile enemies and obstructors will be turned back. Crops, fruits, and juices will flourish, ripen, and grow large. No bhūta and no harm of any kind will be able to assail one.

The dhāraṇī called Vajra Meteoric Iron Beak is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The names of the nāga kings after Sāgara (rendered "Parasol-like," "Great Might," "Great Radiance," and "Fierce") could not be identified with confidence as standard renderings of Sanskrit names, so they are translated by meaning. The last three could also be read as epithets describing the assembled nāga kings ("mighty, radiant and vicious") rather than as names. The "oath formula of the vidyādharas" refers to the nāgas' oath mantra just given. In the final rites the subject "the nāgas" is supplied from context.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.